

■ resolve~tips & tricks

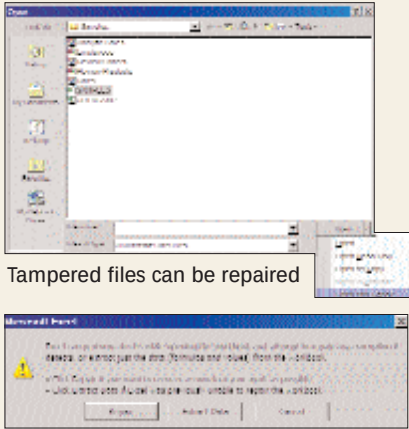
related sheets and colour them together. Alternately, you could choose the Tab colour by selecting Sheets from the Format menu.

 Watch your values

Excel XP has an option that allows you to add watches to cells. When you need values across the sheets within a workbook, you might be required to shuttle to and fro between the sheets. Watches come to the rescue at such moments. Right-click a cell and click on Add watch. A watch window pops up in which all the cells that have a watch are displayed with their corresponding values. This window stays even when you shuttle between sheets. This way it reduces your shuttling between sheets to look for cell values that are required across the workbook.

 Repair them

Excel XP does an automatic repair to corrupt files. It tries to open and repair the file simultaneously. On the other hand, Excel XP also has options for manual repair. Choose Open from the File menu. Select the file to open from the appropriate path and when clicking the Open button, click the arrow next to it and choose Open and Repair from the



Tampered files can be repaired

Excel's repair or extract option

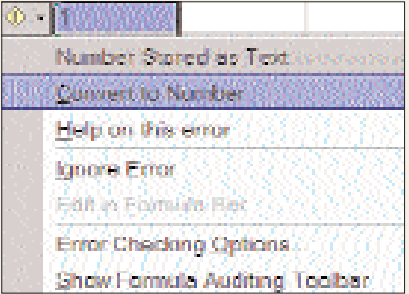
drop-down list. This allows you to repair the file. Upon choosing the Open and Repair option, it gives you options to Repair, Extract data or Cancel. Based on your requirement and condition, choose the appropriate action to be performed.

Note that Excel XP provides other options to repair files at different situations.

 Convert text to numerals

You might want to format certain areas of the Excel sheet with text formatting. You might also accidentally have

numbers in those areas, which might be needed in some critical calculations. Excel XP has the option of converting text-formatted numbers into true numbers. Use Excel's error checking options button. You might notice that any cell which has a number formatted as text will have a small green triangle on the left top corner of the cell. Select the range of cells that have numbers formatted as text. Click the error checking options



Option to change text to numbers

button (a smart tag), which appears next to the selected range of cells. Choose the Convert to Number option from the menu that pops up to convert the numbers to true numbers. Now you can use them for calculations across the workbook.

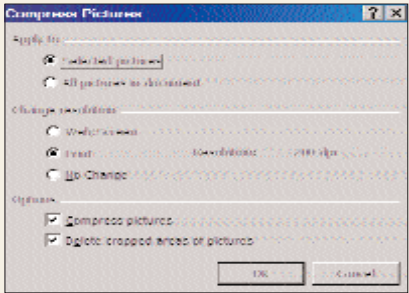
POWERPOINT XP

PowerPoint has more power now. Here's how you can add pizzazz to your presentations

 Compress pictures

Presentation blues? You must have had those when your presentation became too heavy with images. Now there's a way to make your presentations light while retaining all the images. Save the pictures that you have to insert as JPGs, GIFs, or in any other format which is lighter. PowerPoint XP provides an option by which you can compress the embedded images. Click on the images you want compressed by holding down the [Ctrl] key or by selecting them all. Choose the Picture toolbar from View > Toolbars >

Picture. Click on the Compress Pictures button, and choose 'Delete the cropped



Crunch your presentations

areas' of the picture to make the presentation lighter. Just remember that if you compress pictures by selecting Web/Screen, Print, or 'Delete cropped areas of pictures' from the Compress Pictures dialog box, you won't be able to restore images to their original resolution or size.

 Add diagrams

PowerPoint XP offers a new Diagram functionality, which makes it easier to add organisational charts. Select Diagram from the Insert menu from the

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